

Parimala Alva, Ph.D.

AI Educator & AI Enabler | AI Researcher | Generative AI & Agentic AI Practitioner

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI instructor, researcher and practitioner with 20+ years of experience across higher education, and software engineering, combined with hands-on experience building Generative AI and Agentic AI systems (LangChain, LangGraph, RAG, MCP, human-in-the-loop workflows). Skilled at translating complex AI concepts into practical, accessible learning experiences: curricula, hands-on labs, job aids, and mentoring, for diverse audiences across online and in-person settings. Combines deep AI expertise with direct technical fluency in modern AI tools and responsible AI practices, supporting credible, hands-on enablement for teams adopting AI in their day-to-day work.

CORE SKILLS

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| • AI Learning & Enablement | • Generative AI & Agentic AI (LangChain, LangGraph, RAG, MCP) |
| • Learning Program Design | • Prompt Writing & AI Output Review |
| • Learning Program Delivery (Virtual & In-Person) | • Human-in-the-Loop & Responsible AI Practices |
| • Adult Learning Principles | • Program & Project Coordination |
| • Translating AI Concepts for Non-Technical Audiences | • Mentoring & Coaching |
| • Stakeholder Engagement & Communication | • Technology Adoption Support |

EXPERIENCE

Professor, School of Engineering Technology & Applied Science

2016 – Present

Centennial College — Toronto, Canada

- Designed and delivered technical learning programs end-to-end: building course materials, hands-on labs, then refining them iteratively based on learner outcomes and feedback.
- Taught AI, Software Engineering, Linux/Unix Systems, Web Technologies, and Systems Integration to diverse learner populations across hybrid and in-person formats, translating complex technical concepts into practical, applicable material.
- Integrated Generative AI, Agentic AI, and LLM tools such as Claude, Chat GPT etc. into course design and delivery, developing practical exercises and use-case examples that helped learners apply these tools to real technical work.
- Coordinated learning schedules, assessment milestones, and delivery logistics across multiple concurrent courses, balancing competing priorities and stakeholder input in a fast-paced environment.
- Mentored and coached learners through structured lab sessions, one-on-one guidance, and targeted feedback - supporting skill development and building learner confidence with new and unfamiliar technologies.
- Built and maintained assessment and review processes to evaluate learner work for accuracy, completeness, and quality, aligned to defined learning outcomes.
- Collaborated with academic stakeholders to align course content with institutional goals, gathering ongoing feedback to keep materials current and useful.

Visiting Lecturer

2012 – 2014

University of Hertfordshire — UK

- Facilitated hands-on lab sessions and structured mentoring to support learners in applying technical concepts to practical projects.
- Guided final-year capstone projects from planning through execution, coaching students on scoping, timelines, and delivery.
- Contributed to consistent assessment and feedback processes, helping ensure learner work was evaluated against clear, defined criteria.

Software Consultant

Mar 2010 – Jul 2010

Robert Half Technology — Calgary, Canada

- Communicated with business stakeholders to gather requirements, identify pain points, and define improvements for billing system workflows at a satellite communications client.

- Enhanced billing system workflows, translating business requirements into practical technical improvements that increased operational accuracy, efficiency, and reliability.
- Improved existing customer portal functionality giving users seamless, real-time access to usage and billing information, improving transparency and the end-user experience.

Programmer Analyst

2008 – 2009

Metafore — Calgary, Canada

- Communicated with business stakeholders and end users to gather requirements, identify pain points, and define improvements for a job order management system used in the oil well drilling industry.
- Designed and developed system features that translated those requirements into practical functionality.
- Improved end-to-end operational workflows to increase system efficiency, reliability, and process consistency.

Software Engineer

2004 – 2008

Infosys — India

- Coordinated cross-functional collaboration between Canadian business stakeholders and distributed development teams in India, managing communication, timelines, and delivery across a global environment — experience translating business needs into technical deliverables for non-technical stakeholders.
- Developed enterprise software solutions for healthcare, insurance, and railway clients, building organizational and stakeholder-management skills in complex, multi-team settings.

APPLIED GENERATIVE AI & AGENTIC AI PROJECTS

Hosted on Hugging Face: huggingface.co/alvap

- Human-in-the-Loop Clinical Triage Assistant — built using LangGraph, Gradio, and Python, incorporating human review workflows and LangSmith-based traceability and evaluation for reviewing AI-generated outputs.
- Additional Agentic AI workflow demonstrations covering orchestration, task routing, parallel processing, and sequential multi-agent pipelines using LangGraph — exploring patterns for coordinating and reviewing AI agent behavior.

EDUCATION

- Ph.D., Computer Science — University of Hertfordshire, UK (2012–2016)
- MSc, Artificial Intelligence and Robotics — University of Hertfordshire, UK (2011–2012)
- B.E., Computer Science — VTU, India (2001–2005)

** WES-verified academic credentials (Canada)*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- IBM RAG and Agentic AI Professional Certificate — Coursera (May 2026)
- Responsible AI Data Management
- Explainable AI in Python